

Ὅμηρικοὶ ὕμνοι

Gods and Heroes in the Anonymous Hymnic Collection

eul_aid: upu

Period: *Κλασική* Classical
Dialect: *Ἑπική* Epic (Homeric)
Domain: *Ποίησις* Poetry
Format: *Ἑμμετρος* Verse

The Homeric Hymns are a collection of thirty-three ancient Greek poems. They are not the work of a single author but were composed by various unknown poets over several centuries, from the Archaic to the early Classical period, roughly the eighth to the fourth centuries BCE. Although traditionally linked to Homer in antiquity, modern scholars agree they were not written by the author of the Iliad and Odyssey.

The poets were likely professional performers called rhapsodes, who worked within the same oral storytelling tradition as the Homeric epics. The hymns are written in the epic dialect and meter and were composed for performance. They often served as preludes to the recitation of longer epic poetry, aiming to honor a specific god and gain their favor.

The collection varies greatly in length, from very short invocations to lengthy narrative poems. The most substantial hymns are dedicated to Demeter, Apollo, Hermes, and Aphrodite. These longer works tell foundational stories about the gods, such as the abduction of Persephone in the Hymn to Demeter or the mischievous infancy of Hermes.

The collection is a primary source for early Greek religion and mythology. According to modern scholars, the hymns preserve some of the oldest versions of important myths and provide vital insights into ancient cult practices. They bridge the genres of epic and lyric poetry and were influential models for later literary hymns. For contemporary readers, they offer a crucial window into Greek religious thought and the development of epic poetry beyond the most famous Homeric works.

Works (33)

- Ὑμνος εἰς Διόνυσον · Hymn 1 to Dionysus · 2 passages
- Ὑμνος εἰς Ἀφροδίτην · Hymn 10 to Aphrodite · 1 passages
- Ὑμνος εἰς Ἀθηνᾶν · Hymn 11 to Athena · 1 passages
- Ὑμνος εἰς Ἥραν · Hymn 12 to Hera · 1 passages
- Ὑμνος εἰς τὴν Μητέρα τῶν Θεῶν · Hymn 14 Mothe f Gods · 1 passages
- Ὑμνος εἰς Ἡρακλέα τὸν Λέοντα · Hymn 15 To Heracles · 1 passages
- Ὑμνος εἰς Ἀσκληπιόν · Hymn 16 To Asclepius · 1 passages
- Ὑμνος εἰς τοὺς Διοσκούρους · Hymn 17 To the Dioscuri · 1 passages
- Ὑμνος εἰς Ἑρμῆν · Hymn 18 To Hermes · 2 passages
- Ὑμνος εἰς Πᾶνα · Hymn 19 To Pan · 4 passages
- Ὑμνος εἰς Δημήτρα · Hymn 2 To Demeter · 35 passages

- Ὕμνος εἰς Ἥφαιστον · Hymn 20 To Hephaestus · 1 passages
- Ὕμνος εἰς Ἀπόλλωνα · Hymn 21 To Apollo · 1 passages
- Ὕμνος εἰς Ποσειδῶνα · Hymn 22 To Poseidon · 1 passages
- Ὕμνος εἰς Δία · Hymn 23 To Zeus · 1 passages
- Ὕμνος εἰς Ἑστίαν · Hymn 24 To Hestia · 1 passages
- Ὕμνος εἰς τὰς Μούσας καὶ Ἀπόλλωνα · Hymn 25 To the Muses and Apollo · 1 passages
- Ὕμνος εἰς Διόνυσον · Hymn 26 To Dionysus · 2 passages
- Ὕμνος εἰς Ἄρτεμιν · Hymn 27 To Artemis · 2 passages
- Ὕμνος εἰς Ἀθηνᾶν · Hymn 28 To Athena · 2 passages
- Ὕμνος εἰς Ἑστίαν · Hymn 29 To Hestia · 2 passages
- Ὕμνος εἰς Ἀπόλλωνα · Hymn 3 To Apollo · 40 passages
- Ὕμνος εἰς Γῆν · Hymn 30 To Earth · 2 passages
- Ὕμνος πρὸς Ἥλιον · Hymn 31 To Helios · 2 passages
- Ὕμνος πρὸς Σελήνην · Hymn 32 To Selene · 2 passages
- Ὕμνος πρὸς Διοσκόρους · Hymn 33 To the Dioscuri · 2 passages
- Ὕμνος εἰς Ἑρμῆν · Hymn 4 To Hermes · 42 passages
- Ὕμνος εἰς Ἀφροδίτην · Hymn 5 To Aphrodite · 22 passages
- Ὕμνος εἰς Ἀφροδίτην · Hymn 6 To Aphrodite · 2 passages
- Ὕμνος εἰς Διόνυσον · Hymn 7 To Dionysus · 4 passages
- Ὕμνος εἰς Ἄρην · Hymn 8 To Ares · 2 passages
- Ὕμνος εἰς Ἄρτεμιν · Hymn 9 To Artemis · 1 passages
- Εἰς ξένους · To Foreigners · 1 passages